

1 **FACT STATEMENT OF CHANDLER FLYNN**

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3 My name is Chandler Flynn, but you can call me Coach Flynn. I insist. I'm 35 years old and have
4 been teaching science and coaching swimming at Texoma High School (THS) for the last nine
5 school years. Home of the Texoma Terriers – go, fight, yip! I teach AP Biology, AP Chemistry,
6 Biology II, and Chemistry II – the last two are the courses most students take before they can take
7 either AP class. But some students are placed in AP classes immediately based on test scores from
8 middle school and the summer before their freshman year. I'm on the Discipline Board at THS,
9 which is made up of two teachers and the principal, and we review the more serious student
10 disciplinary matters and determine any appropriate punishment. I have been on that Board since
11 May 2024, and I believe we deliver appropriate justice and remediation in all cases.
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13 I'm also the head swimming coach for the Varsity and Junior Varsity swim teams at THS, a job
14 I've had since I joined THS in 2016. I have two assistant coaches – one for each team – but I run
15 all swim practices, try-outs, and competition strategy. As for my own schooling, I graduated from
16 THS myself in 2010 and attended Texoma A&M University. I graduated *cum laude* with a double
17 major in Chemistry and Physical Education in 2014. I also swam on the University Swim Team;
18 my teammates and coaches called me the “Fin” back then. Right after college, I served with Teach
19 for America teaching middle school. I did that for two years before joining THS. I badly wanted
20 to teach swimming and science; THS offered both. It was a perfect fit.
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22 This whole case has been a nightmare for me and the students. I'm glad to be able to testify against
23 Charlie Quartz. Given what they knew Grady was up to before the killing, Charlie bears full
24 responsibility for this murder. Charlie should have absolutely seen this coming. I first met Grady
25 at the beginning of the 2025-26 school year. School started on August 18, 2025. Grady had tested
26 into my AP Chemistry class, the only freshman in AP Chem that semester. The rest of the class
27 were mostly seniors with a handful of juniors and three sophomores. I remember there were three
28 sophomores because I assigned one of them, Kennedy Dixon, to be Grady's lab partner. I always
29 found it best to pair students in the same year or close to the same year as possible; pairing
30 freshmen with seniors had never proven successful to me.
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32 I hold try-outs for the Varsity and JV swim teams in late August or early September every year.
33 No one is guaranteed to make any team, even if they were on a particular team the year before.
34 The try-outs are pretty standard for a high school swim team. After stretching and warm-ups, we
35 evaluate each student's technique in the four major strokes (freestyle, backstroke, breaststroke,
36 and butterfly) as well as their starts, turns, and finishes. Then, the students compete in two timed
37 events: a 100-yard freestyle, and a 200-yard medley where they race one length doing each of the
38 four major strokes. The timed races are the most crucial for team assignment, as it evaluates actual
39 race ability, conditioning, and endurance. Of course, I am also watching for signs of strong work
40 ethic, a team mentality, and a willingness to listen and accept instruction. Forty-eight students
41 tried out for the swim teams on August 29. I had room for 15 on the Varsity team and 12 on the
42 JV team. One of my assistant coaches told me about Grady before try-outs, and it sounded like
43 Grady had considerable swim talent for a freshman. I always keep an open mind – for new students
44 and returning students – when making selections for each team.
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1 I posted the teams on the bulletin board in the locker room the morning of September 2, the day
2 after Labor Day. Grady made the JV team. While I had toyed with putting him on Varsity, Grady's
3 200-yard medley was slower than most of the other students – and much slower than I would have
4 anticipated based on their 100-yard freestyle time. After I posted the teams, Grady approached me
5 after class and claimed that Julien Younger, a senior and Varsity Captain, had fudged with his
6 medley race time. Julien had the stopwatches for two lanes during the 200-yard medley along with
7 me and the two other coaches, and I know Julien did time Grady during the medley. But I saw the
8 stopwatch time myself – it's not like Julien just made it up out of thin air. Grady said Julien must
9 have started their stopwatch early, but I never considered that a possibility based on what I knew
10 about Julien's honesty, leadership, and even temper.

11
12 Pretty soon after that, I noticed increasing tension between those two – in class and during swim
13 practice. Mostly, Julien would make some snide remarks at or about Grady. That would get all
14 the other seniors laughing and giggling. I wouldn't say Julien was bullying. It was maybe close
15 to the line if you're sensitive, sure, but nothing that serious. Still, I put a stop to the teasing every
16 time I witnessed it. It was maybe a week after try-outs – September 8 – when things started to
17 escalate. I was trying to start my AP Chemistry class and was telling students to stop chatting and
18 take their seats. Julien went to sit down and his whole desk collapsed on itself. I was worried that
19 Julien might be hurt – he was my best swimmer after all – but he seemed to be OK other than a
20 little ego bruise. Julien pointed right at Grady and said he knew Grady had done it; Grady just
21 grinned back at Julien, this slow sly little grin. I could tell Julien was getting worked up, so I sent
22 him to the nurse to make sure he was OK. Grady was also whispering at the time with Kennedy,
23 but I couldn't hear what they were saying. I looked at the desk heap, and it was clear to me there
24 were a bunch of screws missing. The ones from the joints that held the desk together. Since Grady
25 was clearly the obvious suspect, I searched his backpack but there was nothing. He offered to let
26 me search him, but I knew that was exactly what he wanted. I couldn't punish him since I didn't
27 have any actual evidence, but I told Grady very clearly to knock off any more pranks on Julien. I
28 also sent an email note to Grady's parent, Charlie, so they knew what their son had been doing –
29 and to inform them that I believed Grady was set on getting back at Julien in some way based on
30 what I had overheard him saying to Kennedy a few times.

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32 Two days later, there was a pretty loud bang outside my classroom. I ran out to see where the
33 noise came from and saw Julien was on the ground near his locker. He was caked in sparkly blue
34 and pink confetti, which was everywhere in the hallway. A few of the other students were
35 snickering – until Julien yelled at them to stop. Julien got up and punched one of the lockers hard.
36 Really hard. I told Julien to calm down and checked on him, his face and his right hand. There
37 were a few pieces of confetti that had gotten into Julien's eyes, and we washed that out using one
38 of those eye-wash stations in each science classroom. Julien seemed alright after that and
39 fortunately his hand wasn't broken or anything. But I remember Julien told me he was going to
40 get back at Grady for it. I didn't see Grady in the hallway at the time. Secretly, I also thought
41 Grady had set the confetti bomb. I didn't say that to Julien, of course.

42
43 There was a school investigation into that prank, but the security footage from the hallway was too
44 grainy and crowded to definitively see Grady – or anyone else, frankly – put the confetti thing in
45 Julien's locker. But about ten minutes before the last class let out, the video sort of glitches to a
46 black screen and stays there for about two minutes until it fizzles away. Class lets out a few

1 minutes later, and Julien is blasted with confetti a minute after that. The cameras also only run
2 during the day, so it's always possible Grady broke into the school overnight and set the thing in
3 Julien's locker, but I'm just guessing based on what I know about Grady. Breaking and entering
4 is right up Grady's alley. Although I've never heard of any report of anyone breaking into the
5 school during my entire time here. They do keep the place locked up real tight these days.

6
7 I questioned Grady the next morning along with the principal about the confetti bomb, but he
8 denied having anything to do with it. A likely story. I could see the same smug grin hiding under
9 the surface of Grady's face – he had definitely done it. And he relished he was getting away with
10 it. On the way out, Grady said he was looking forward to the lab experiment we were doing on
11 Monday. It sounded genuine, and Grady was a good student, so I didn't pay any mind to it then.
12 I sent another message to Charlie about Grady and asked for a meeting to discuss Grady's behavior.
13 Both of my emails to Charlie Quartz are in Exhibit 2; emails like those were how I regularly
14 communicated with parents about their kids. It's always better to have those things in writing than
15 trying to have a phone call; things get misheard and just trying to get anyone on the phone these
16 days is a hassle.

17
18 On Monday, September 15, we were doing a fairly simple lab experiment in chemical kinetics,
19 which is a standard part of the AP Chemistry curriculum. The purpose of the lab was to
20 demonstrate how changes in variables, like concentration and temperature, can affect the rate of a
21 chemical reaction. Students had performed this specific experiment in prior years, always without
22 any issues. Instead of having students mix chemicals to create the various solutions they need, I
23 create those myself prior to the lab and put them in each lab station right before class starts. This
24 also ensures students don't know exactly what the solutions are. The students' job was to measure
25 specified amounts of those solutions, combine them in a sequence described in their instructions,
26 observe what they saw, and record the time required for the reaction to reach a designated endpoint.

27
28 The expected reaction was not supposed to be dramatic. No flames, no explosion, no significant
29 release of energy. The students were supposed to see a gradual observable change in the mixture,
30 record the reaction time, and then repeat the experiment under slightly different conditions. Five
31 minutes into the exercise, I heard Julien yell, "Woah Coach, I'm cooked!" I looked over and saw
32 his glass vessel shatter across the lab station with glass fragments everywhere. The heat or smoke
33 from the blast set off the school's fire protection sprinkler system. Water was pouring from the
34 ceiling. I immediately stopped the exercise and directed students into the hallway – and then
35 outside using the evacuation route. Several kids in my class had a few minor cuts from the glass
36 shards, Julien included, but no one else had any injuries. Everyone was evaluated by the EMTs
37 who arrived with the fire department and, fortunately, everyone was OK.

38
39 At first, I could not explain what happened. I check the equipment before every lab class, and I
40 personally test all solutions and ingredients that will be used during experiments to ensure safety
41 of the students and the school. I am certain that I provided the proper solutions for the experiment,
42 and no issues had ever occurred in the years I've held that experiment in class. Now, though, I am
43 certain Grady had to have made a switch in Julien's lab stuff. I just can't tell you how he did it.
44 However he did it, he got Julien to unknowingly combine two solutions that are highly volatile
45 when combined. That released a significant amount of energy, heat, and smoke that broke the
46 glass vessel and set off the overhead sprinklers. The school didn't find anything in their

1 investigation, and I was questioned since the reaction happened with solutions I had prepared. I
2 cooperated fully, but I did suggest they search Grady given his clear path of vengeance against
3 Julien. Nothing was in Grady's locker linking them to the solution switch, but the search didn't
4 start until the next day. Grady was a super smart kid. There's no way he would leave evidence in
5 his locker overnight that would tie him to a prank that could have killed multiple people. But I
6 had seen enough. Something needed to be done to stop Grady's antics against Julien.

7
8 On September 18, the Discipline Board convened to discuss Grady's actions in the lab explosion,
9 confetti bomb, desk tampering, and potential punishment. This was on my recommendation to the
10 Board, which was fully supported by the principal. We interviewed Grady – with Charlie present
11 at the hearing – and allowed Grady to respond to the allegations. The entire hearing was recorded
12 and transcribed; you can see a transcript, if you're curious, in Exhibit 3. Grady tried to deny
13 everything and demanded we provide evidence. Honestly, we didn't have anything conclusive,
14 but it wasn't a courtroom, so we didn't have some legal standard to abide by. We did ask Grady
15 detailed questions about all three incidents to get his answers on the record – and to make sure
16 Charlie, who was there, knew about Grady's crazy behavior. After the hearing, the Board
17 unanimously agreed to suspend Grady for one week from school – one of the harshest penalties
18 we have short of expulsion. Grady threatened us after we announced our decision, telling us that
19 false witnesses "always get their due." I wish we had been able to look at Grady's phone, but we
20 don't have the ability to seize a student's phone – and no student ever gives it up when asked.

21
22 After Grady returned from his one-week suspension on September 26, and pretty much through
23 the fall semester, I was astonished by his good behavior. Grady had been allowed to continue
24 practicing on the swim team when he returned from suspension – as long as there wasn't a single
25 antic – but he couldn't compete in any races or meets unless the school allowed it. As we
26 approached Thanksgiving break, Grady's classroom behavior and attitude at swim practice was
27 consistently angelic – he was quieter, more focused academically, and fully receptive to correction
28 and direction at swim practice. I even saw him listen intently to Julien at practice as Julien
29 criticized some of his technique while calling him "Goldy," like a goldfish. And then saw Grady
30 implement whatever Julien said with faster times on his next set of laps. I don't recall any other
31 specific interactions between those two – which is why the senior-coaching-freshman moment at
32 practice was so memorable to me. Grady and Julien didn't really interact during my class after the
33 suspension other than me hearing Julien call Grady "Goldy" several times. But Grady never
34 reacted so I didn't do anything about it. Now I know Grady was lulling every single one of us into
35 complacency – the perfect setting for his horrid crime.

36
37 Because of this sustained improvement, the school allowed Grady to compete in the State
38 Championships. I thought he had earned a second chance; I was so wrong. The State
39 Championships were held at THS because of our Olympic-size swimming pool, and that year's
40 competition happened on November 22. The JV races go first, then the Varsity ones since those
41 are the most competitive and favored by the crowd. I was there the whole time since I coached
42 both teams. Grady competed in two races – won them both – and was finished by about noon.
43 There were still a couple more JV races to go after that, followed promptly by the first Varsity
44 race, and I remember talking to Grady because I – ugh – told him how proud I was of him lately;
45 Grady just smiled and said "thanks" before heading toward the locker rooms. I still can't believe
46 that was moments before Grady murdered Julien. I haven't seen Grady since that last eerie

1 conversation. Julien had three races himself that day, including the very first Varsity one, the 200-
2 meter freestyle. He finished fourth, and I thought he looked sluggish on the final lap – his speed
3 fading more than I’ve ever seen in four years. So, I went up to him after the race to ask if he was
4 feeling alright. Julien brushed me off, said he was fine, and headed back to the locker room. It
5 was minutes later that I heard someone yell 9-1-1.

6
7 I sprinted into the locker room and found Julien on the floor with his muscles jerking around like
8 they were all spasming. He didn’t respond to me calling out his name, and there was a pulse,
9 heartbeat, and breathing – just all erratic and racing. An ambulance and police arrived incredibly
10 fast, maybe a minute after I found Julien, and they raced him to the hospital. I showed one of the
11 cops where Julien’s locker was and made sure one of the other coaches was contacting Julien’s
12 parents and knew which hospital the ambulance was headed to. Then, I talked to the rest of the
13 Varsity team and a couple of the JV swimmers who were still there. I told them not to worry, even
14 though I’m sure I looked incredibly worried myself. We eventually called off the rest of the swim
15 meet. That took a while but was a decision all the other coaches agreed with. I went to the hospital
16 to visit Julien later that evening, but I was not allowed to see him because he was still in really bad
17 shape. I learned the next morning he had passed away. I was heartbroken. I offered to do anything
18 I could to help with the funeral and things, but I never got around to that because the next week
19 was like a whirlwind nightmare.

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21 The day after Julien died, I was interviewed by a police officer named Detective Reyne who asked
22 me a bunch of questions about whether anyone held a grudge against Julien. I immediately said
23 Grady. The cops must have already been onto him because the Detective nodded as soon as I
24 mentioned Grady’s name. I talked about the interactions between Grady and Julien, and what I
25 remembered from the day of the swim meet. I learned a day or two later that Julien had been
26 poisoned! At some point I learned it was Clartaxin. I had heard of that toxin before but it’s not
27 something that I’ve studied, and I certainly have never taught anything about it or how to make it.
28 Grady was a sharp kid and very gifted in chemistry, so I am 100% confident Grady had the
29 knowledge and skill to make that stuff – even though I admittedly don’t exactly know how to make
30 it. Just goes to show how premeditated Grady’s murder was on Julien. I tried to look up as much
31 information about Clartaxin as I could, just in case I had seen something that might help the cops
32 convict Grady, but I found it extremely difficult to find anything online or in textbooks about it.
33 Even my chemistry books from my college studies didn’t have much of anything about it.

34
35 Further affiant sayeth naught.

36 *Chandler Flynn*

37 CHANDLER FLYNN

38
39 **SIGNED AND SWORN TO BEFORE ME** the undersigned authority on this the 15th
40 day of December, 2025.

